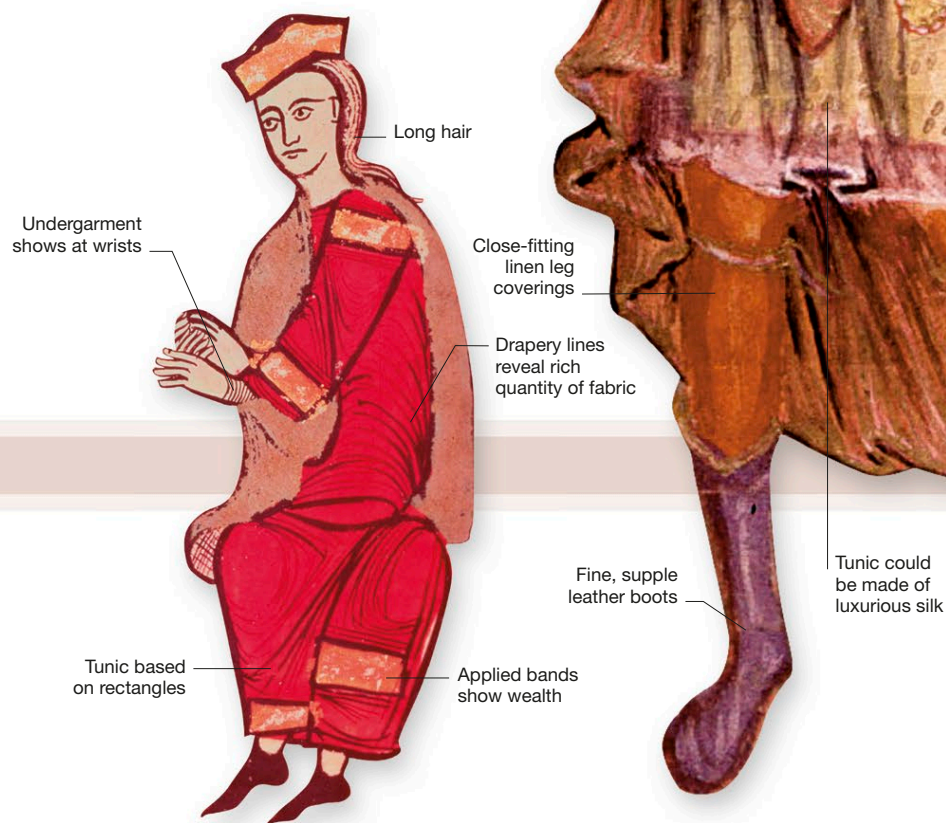




Vikings at work Two 12th-century Norwegian men mending a sword wear wool tunics, belted at the waist. Summer Viking raids brought new fashions and rare accessories back to Norse regions.



Catalan noble Men's and women's dress could be so similar that it was hard to tell the sexes apart. This Iberian noble from the 7th century could be a lord or a lady, as both wore long clothes, soft shoes, and long hair.



Royal splendour As befits a ruler, Frankish King Charles II wears fine-quality clothing, c.870. His long mantle covers a tunic and leg coverings, although classical writers thought that trousers were barbaric.



Carolingian style Emperor Charlemagne's son, Louis the Pious, d.840, wears sumptuous silk and gem-encrusted clothing. The damask mantle is particularly extravagant in its colour and pearl motifs.

JEWELLERY



Replica Viking amulets

Jewellery was a means of adornment and also a form of portable wealth, easily carried and used as payment. People living around the Baltic Sea collected amber, the fossilized resin of prehistoric trees, and traded it across Europe and beyond. Precious metals, such as gold, and jewels had a nearly sacred attribution due to their rarity. Other metals used included bronze, iron, copper, and tin. Glass beads appear in many Norse graves. Men and women held clothing together with ornate round pins and brooches, and wore shapely belt buckles, rings, and earrings.